





Territory Acknowledgment

The Art Gallery of Greater Victoria acknowledges it is located on the traditional territories of the lək'ənən Peoples, today known as the Songhees and Esquimalt Nations. As guests on these lands we extend our appreciation for the opportunity to live and learn on their territory.

Foreword

The Art Gallery of Greater Victoria (AGGV) has been a vibrant member of the city's arts community since a volunteer group of artists began "The Little Arts Centre" in the 1940s. Over 80 years later, the AGGV welcomes over 70,000 visitors each year, houses the largest public collection in British Columbia, and is supported by valued members, donors, funders, volunteers, an expert staff and dedicated board of directors.

The AGGV is at an exciting crossroads—one that includes plans for a long-anticipated return to downtown, and much more. The Gallery will be guided in the next stage of its journey by this new strategic plan and particularly by the strategic vision, mission and values that emerged from conversations with the community—Indigenous Peoples, the public, members, donors, artists, arts leaders, educators, and volunteers. **Thank you to everyone who contributed to our new shared strategic vision: *Together in Art*.**

Over the next five years, the Gallery will focus on the **key strategic priorities** outlined in this plan.

We look forward to **collaborating with the community** to produce thought-provoking exhibitions and programs that matter to an increasingly broad and diverse community.

The Collection will be the inspiration and foundation for telling resonant stories. Using different mediums, putting art and artists at the centre of programming, the Gallery will engage with people in new and exciting ways.

The Gallery will **provide opportunities for inclusive and welcoming art experiences for all.** Everyone should be able to see themselves when they walk through the door of a Gallery that is barrier-free and meets the operational needs of a 21st-century art museum.

We are committed to **building the understanding and trust that are critical for strong relationships with Indigenous communities.** We wish to honour the Indigenous principle of "nothing about us without us." This begins with listening, learning, and working together to break down historical barriers and find pathways to reconciliation.

The Gallery looks forward to building and nurturing all relationships—ensuring they are centered around equity, diversity, inclusion and accessibility for people of all ages and backgrounds, and in a truly inclusive space.

Thank you for joining the AGGV as we work *Together in Art* to create a new future for the Gallery and our community.

IMAGE CREDITS

Programming, exhibition, and engagement photos used throughout this document are courtesy of the Art Gallery of Greater Victoria, unless otherwise noted.

COVER (top left)

Michael Snow, *Bikini* (detail), 1963, oil on canvas, overall: 154 x 227.7 cm Robert A. Laidlaw Fund, AGGV 1969.064.001 a-c.

INSIDE COVER (top right)

Dana Claxton, *Headdress – Connie*, 2019, LED Firebox with transmounted chromogenic transparency, Courtesy of the artist.

BACK COVER

(top left) Cedar weaving workshop at the AGGV with Jessica Sault, Nuu-chah-nulth from the Tseshaht First Nation, and Cheyanne Tinoco from the Cowichan Nation.

(bottom left) Installation image of *Adorned* exhibition at the AGGV, featuring artist Meghan O'Brien.





Our Vision

The Art Gallery of Greater Victoria is a welcoming public space that encourages dialogue and understanding through art.

Our Mission

The Art Gallery of Greater Victoria connects people and art to build a better understanding of our world. We are an accessible gathering place for people to experience art through exhibitions, programs, and other media and to create spaces for conversation and learning. We responsibly steward the collections for future generations.

We Value



ART AND ARTISTS

We believe in the power of art and artists to bring us together.



CHANGE

We strive to adapt to and inspire change and create relevant experiences for the community.



COURAGE

We take chances and use art to challenge the status quo.



BELONGING

We foster belonging by centering equity, diversity, and inclusion in all that we do.



CURIOSITY

We embrace learning, new ideas, and welcome critical perspectives.

Where We're Headed 2025–2030

1

STRATEGIC GOAL

Create a welcoming and inclusive art experience.

WHAT WILL THIS LOOK LIKE?

- The AGGV is a welcoming and accessible space for all to enjoy art, in person and online.
- The AGGV audiences grow and are more diverse.
- Greater collaborations across disciplines expand our reach and strengthen the art experience.

2

STRATEGIC GOAL

Animate our collection to tell stories.

WHAT WILL THIS LOOK LIKE?

- The collection is at the heart of our programming.
- Access to the collection is improved.
- The collection is more representative of the diversity of contemporary society.

3

STRATEGIC GOAL

Center Indigenous voices and perspectives in Gallery operations.

WHAT WILL THIS LOOK LIKE?

- Activating the Canadian Museum Association's *Moved to Action* report as a guide:
- Decisions related to Indigenous art and artists are made by and with Indigenous People.
 - AGGV policies support Indigenous rights, practice, and knowledge.
 - AGGV grows Indigenous collections, programs, and exhibitions.
 - AGGV builds, sustains, and retains Indigenous relationships.

4

STRATEGIC GOAL

Build a new gallery.

WHAT WILL THIS LOOK LIKE?

- We have a plan to successfully deliver the project.
- The Gallery has a clear operational plan for the future.
- The new Gallery will be informed by community conversations.

5

STRATEGIC GOAL

Strengthen operational resilience.

WHAT WILL THIS LOOK LIKE?

- We are financially and environmentally sustainable.
- Increased awareness of who we are and our impact.
- We center equity, diversity, inclusion, and accessibility to create a safe and healthy organizational culture.



Our Collection

With over 22,000 works of art, the Art Gallery has the largest public collection in British Columbia, including the most important collection of Asian art in Western Canada.



1 Auguste Rodin, *Mercury Emerging from a Cloud (Study for the Gates of Hell)*, n.d., bronze, overall (measurements for figure) 35.5 x 37.5 x 18.5 cm, Mrs. Massy Gooden Purchase Fund, AGGV.1964.075.001
2 Lawren S. Harris, *Mountain Sketch LI (Near Moraine Lake)*, n.d., oil, image: 37.5 x 29.5 cm, Gift of Ian and Andrew Burchett from the estate of their parents, Peter and Damaris Burchett, AGGV.2019.021.003
3 Terrance Houle, *Urban Indian Series (#7)*, Photographer: Jarusha Brown, 2007, digital C print, LightJet; colour, 72.4 x 92.9 cm, Honouring John McCaig for 6 years of service on the AGGV Board of Directors from 2008-2014, AGGV.2010.022.001 **4** Sophie Pemberton, *Untitled (Portrait of a Girl)*, 1902, oil, overall (image/support): 63.5 x 76.3 cm, Estate of Theresa Susan Yoder Moyle, AGGV.1989.002.001 **5** Kent Monkman, *Watercolour Study for Constellation of Knowledge (Cobalt)* (detail), 2022, watercolour on acid-free paper, 55.8 x 74.9 cm, AGGV.2023.012.001 **6** Takao Tanabe, *Skeena #2*, 1970, acrylic, overall: 86.4 x 85 cm, Gift of the Artist, AGGV.2004.031.013 **7** Hjalmer Wenstob, *Bentwood Box*, 2017, styrofoam, operculum shells, overall: 45.7 x 61 x 30.5 cm, Purchased with the assistance of Donna and John de Haan. In memory of Stella S. Zwirzenski, AGGV 2020.008.001 a.b **8** *Kraak Charger with Birds and Vegetation Motif*, porcelain; blue underglaze, overall (diameter of rim): 10 x 49.7 cm base (diameter of rim): 26.2 cm, Gift of Alice H. and Ramsay Gordon Cooper, AGGV.1993.067.001



9 Edward John Hughes, *Steamer at the Old Wharf, Nanaimo*, 1958, oil, overall (support; sight: 60.3 x 93; framed: 77.0 x 110): 61 x 94 cm, Gift of Mary Alice Segal, Miles Keenleyside, Anne Katherine McCullum and Sara Lynn Jackson, AGGV.1992.056.001 **10** Kano Sanraku, *Peacocks and Pine Trees* (Screen from *Nijo Castle, Kyoto*), c.1620, mineral colours, gold leaf, overall: 216 x 2332.2 cm, Gift of Uno and Dianne Langmann, AGGV.1995.019.001 **11** Brendan Tang, *Manga Ormolu Version 5.0a*, 2014, ceramic, overall: 47 x 21.5 x 21.5 cm, Purchased with the support of the Canada Council for the Arts Acquisition Grants program and the George and Lola Kidd BC Art Acquisitions Fund, AGGV.2015.012.001 **12** Emily Carr, *Odds and Ends*, 1939, oil, overall: 67.4 x 109.5 cm, Formerly in the collection of the Greater Victoria Public Library, transferred to the Art Gallery of Greater Victoria, AGGV.1998.001.001 **13** Walter Joseph Phillips, *York Boat on Lake Winnipeg*, 1930, woodcut (medium remarks: ink, black, grey green, red, blue, green, dark brown, ochre, yellow, grey, buff), overall: 26.1 x 35 cm, Gift of Mrs. H.V. Bartholomew, AGGV.1965.090.001 **14** France Trépanier, *Refuge: Shelter*, 2021, pastel, charcoal, 154.2 x 101.6 cm, Purchased from the artist, AGGV.2022.018.004 **15** Alfred Joseph Casson, *Summer Morning, Bon Echo Rock, Lake Mazinaw*, 1959, oil, overall: 60.5 x 76 cm, Gift of George & Lola Kidd, AGGV.2008.003.025

| Our Impact

AGGV impacts the community in many ways: fostering social cohesion, improving visitors' wellbeing, creating community and belonging, improving our society, creating change, and affecting lives. Here are some of the ways we accomplish this:



"The exhibition tour was an amazing experience. It was fascinating learning about the different lives of the artists behind the artwork. As a first-generation immigrant, I could resonate a lot with the stories that were told. The gallery is a beautiful place with so much culture."

—STUDENT



"The sheer size of the Art Gallery Paint-In shows how active our artistic community is in Victoria. It is amazing to have a place and time where we can all share our work with the greater community and meet one another."

—LOCAL ARTIST



"Thank-you again for your assistance with booking and with your informative and engaging school tour! I loved the hands-on activities for the students, how they were engaged in group discussions, and that they had time to share and ask questions during the tour."

—TEACHER



"One of the best art galleries I've been to across Canada."

—VISITOR



"I appreciated the beautiful installations at the AGGV. There were many interactive pieces which we were able to take part in."

—VISITOR



"Visiting the galleries today was a visual and emotional delight, thank you for opening all the doors so I could access the galleries in my wheelchair."

—VISITOR

| Our Role

WHAT MAKES US DIFFERENT?

With over 22,000 works of art, the Art Gallery has the largest public collection in British Columbia including one of the most important collections of Asian art in North America.

When it first opened in 1951, the Art Gallery of Greater Victoria exhibited art in the historic 1889 mansion that is now adjacent to its seven modern galleries, which were added in the 1950s and 1970s.

We play a starring role as an arts and cultural attraction in the Provincial Capital Region. The AGGV is situated on the traditional lands of the Songhees and Esquimalt Nations, who have hosted visitors from near and far for centuries. We hope to honour their spirit by welcoming all people to our spaces.

By working *Together in Art* through **collaboration and partnerships**, and the continued **support of our amazing donors**, the AGGV promises to uphold its relationship to everyone we serve; and to continue to **foster social cohesion and promote education**; to serve as **a safe convenor of conversation and community**, and be **a point of pride** for all people of this province.

As a major arts and culture asset with an internationally-renowned collection, we have a lead role in contributing to cultural development in the province and to showcasing our creative city. We share in the City's vision of "Victoria radiating creativity and thriving as a home to creative people and everyday artistic encounters."

teachers **artists** people with disabilities museums galleries
funders collectors corporations **visitors** families interest-holders board sponsors
outreach tourists indigenous pride education staff colleges immigrants
wholesalers members parents YYJ volunteers
businesses **2SLGBTQI+** schools
donors city builders
universities
funders



What We Heard

Our Strategic Vision is Informed by You!

BIG CULTURAL SECTOR SHIFTS AND OUR PLANNING CONTEXT

Like any sector, the cultural sector has experienced major social, technological, economic, and environmental shifts in recent years which continue to play out, and our strategic goals intentionally reflect these considerations.

- Truth and Reconciliation
- Shifting life cycle of arts organizations
- Equity, diversity, inclusion, and accessibility
- New approaches to art-making
- Responding to community issues with arts-based interventions and strategies
- New operating, funding, and governance models
- Generational considerations
- Festivals and events are a leading way for participatory cultural consumption
- Technology including immersive experiences, digital competencies, and AI
- Climate crisis

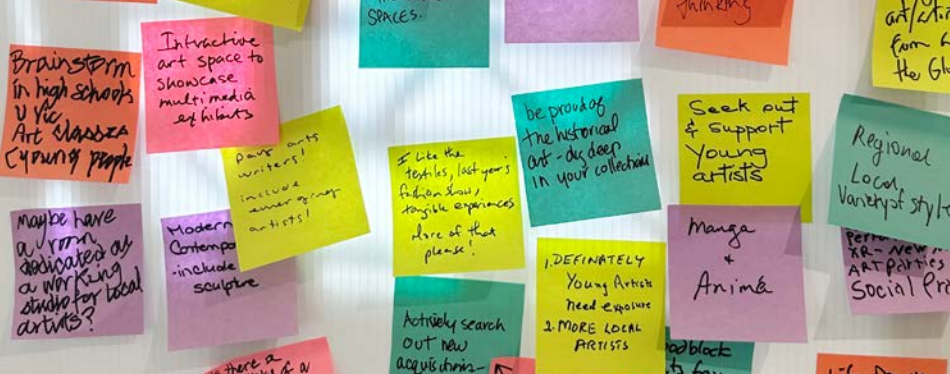
HOW WE ENGAGED

The AGGV is grateful to all those who contributed their voices to shaping our future direction—*Together in Art*—including over 500 sources of individual input we have gathered, themed, and analyzed. Thank you!

The AGGV's engagement journey took place over two years and included a variety of ways to listen to our members, donors, visitors, artists, the Indigenous community, as well as the public. This included:

- Community workshops
- Interviews with groups representing IBPOC, 2SLGBTQI+, people with disabilities, and newcomers
- Public survey
- Open houses
- Educator surveys
- Indigenous Community Roundtable
- Donor/member sessions
- Board and staff workshops
- Board and management strategic planning retreat





How We Move Ahead

And Work Together in Art

Together in Art requires building trust with everyone we serve. Active listening and collaboration will be critical as we step out the supporting actions to our strategic vision.

As we look more deeply at our programming and at ways to animate the collection, a key metric will be outlining ways to share diverse and transformative art experiences that invite curiosity.

Other ways of measuring our success will include identifying supporting actions to our strategic vision that bring people more joy and happiness—we want to be a point of pride and a place that celebrates our community and its relationship to art.

The supporting actions to this vision also need to ensure that people's voices continue to be reflected in the strategy's implementation—that is just another way we can build trust as we work *Together in Art*.

Be a Part of It!

- Visit the Gallery
- Participate in programming
- Attend openings and events
- Become a member
- Donate today
- Leave a legacy
- Follow us and share on socials

aggv.ca/support

ABOVE (bottom left)

Installation image of *Afroquatics: A Call and Response Below the Surface* featuring work by Kemi Craig.

LEFT (far left)

Indigenous engagement at the AGGV. Photo courtesy of Called to Action Collaborative.



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